



Mental Health Trends from Survey Data

Ethical Guidelines for Mental Health Hub

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Project: 2 Lachesis

Task: Mental Health Trends from Survey Data

Purpose: These guidelines outline how our simulated Mental Health Hub project handles sensitive data in a way that protects user privacy, avoids harm, and promotes respectful, inclusive digital wellbeing. Even though our tools use only public or fake data, we believe in modelling ethical best practices from the start.

Our Ethical Commitments

1. We Only Use Safe and Anonymous Data

All data in our platform is either fake (simulated by us) or from trusted, anonymised public sources like the ABS or Our World in Data. No real personal data is used or stored.

2. We Don't Collect Identifiable Information

Users never need to give names, emails, login details, or any information that could be used to identify them. All interactions are private and session-based.

3. User Participation is 100% Voluntary

All surveys, check-ins, and tools are optional. Users can skip any part or exit the platform without penalty or pressure.

4. Our Mood Prediction Tool is Just a Simulation

We clearly state that the mood tool is for demonstration only. It is not a medical assessment and should not be treated as advice. Users are gently reminded that real support should come from a qualified mental health professional.

5. We Avoid Judgemental or Harmful Language

All content on our platform is written in supportive, inclusive, and non-judgemental language. We never suggest that mood states are "good" or "bad" — only that they are normal and valid.

6. The Chatbot Doesn't Give Medical Advice

Our chatbot provides general wellbeing information and resource links. It does not offer counselling, therapy, or any form of diagnosis. This is stated clearly during all interactions.

7. We Don't Store User Inputs

Any mood check-ins or survey responses entered by users are temporary and disappear once the session ends. There is no backend logging of responses unless explicitly stated and ethically justified.

8. We Design for Privacy by Default

All features are created with privacy in mind. Data is never collected unless necessary, and only in ways that are transparent and respectful. If we simulate user input, we label it clearly as a mock example.

9. We Promote Inclusion and Emotional Safety

In line with the Collaborative Confidence Model, our platform celebrates diverse experiences and encourages peer validation. It is designed to be welcoming across age, gender, culture, and ability.

10. We Are Honest About Limitations

We openly communicate what our tools can and can't do. We avoid over-promising and always remind users that this is a simulated project, not a health service.

Final Note

If this were a real platform, we would take additional steps such as encryption, secure hosting, ethical review, and written user consent. But even in a demo, **we prioritise safety, trust, and empathy in every decision.**